Spandrel from an Archway

From the khanqah of Baybars al-Gashankir

Bahri Mamluk, 709-10 AH / 1309-10 CE

W: 17.5 cm; H: 181 cm

Inv. no. 479



This spandrel, originating from the khanqah founded by Sultan Baybars al-Gashankir (709-10 AH / 1309-10 CE), likely formed part of the frame surrounding the front doors of a minbar, although the original minbar itself no longer survives. The carvings, typical of the Ayyubid and Mamluk periods, feature scrolling arabesques, trilobed fleurons, large leaves, and downward curling buds rendered in relief. Comparable motifs appear on the spandrils of the mausoleum's keel-arched entrance, set within a

perforated screen executed in maymouni-style woodturning. The Museum also houses two other wooden pieces from the khanqah: a cupboard, Inv. No. 478, and a window shutter with its frame and leaves, Inv. No. 480, the latter suspected to have been reused from a Fatimid palace on the same site.

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